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Man 1:
Why, whatever is the matter, Emily?

Woman 1:
Joe, Joe, are you all right? Let me look at you, Joe!

Man 1:
Of course I'm all right. Why shouldn't I be all right?

Woman 1:
But, Joe, all that hammering and sawing.

Man 1:
Oh, that! That was only the dentist trying to force open his instrument cabinet.

Woman 1: His cabinet?

Man 1: Yes, you see he lost the key.

Woman 1:
So he hasn't done anything to you, Joe!

Man 1:
Not a thing, and I can't wait any longer this morning. I've made an appointment with him for this evening instead. The nurse gave me some pills to deaden the pain in the meantime.

Woman 1: Oh, Joe, I was so upset.

Man 1 :
Well, it's all right now, Emily, so let's go.

(Woman 1 and Man 1 go out left. A moment later the Nurse enters from the surgery. She is walking across the stage when the Dentist enters left. The Dentist is waving a key.)

Dentist:
I found it. Believe it or not, but it was under the telephone directory. What an awful waste of time!

Nurse:
I'm afraid the first patient couldn't wait. However, he made an appointment for this evening.

Dentist:
Fair enough. I'll take the next patient.

(Dentist goes into the surgery. Nurse turns to Woman 5 who is still looking at her photographs.)

Nurse :
Now, madam, the dentist is ready.

(Woman 5 looks up.)

Woman 5**:** Do you mean me, Miss?

Nurse:
Yes, would you step into the surgery, please?

(Nurse goes into the surgery.)

Woman 5:
Dear me, that long queue did move quickly, didn't it?

(Woman 5 follows the Nurse into the surgery.) **CURTAIN**

About the Author

Christopher Victor Burgess is known as C V Burgess. He is a humorous playwright. His situational humour intensifies the emotions of the characters in the play. His plays usually accommodate a number of characters. His famous works are *'Short Plays for Large Classes'*, *'Teach yourself Speech Training'* and *'Classroom Playhouse Verse in Action'*.